

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Comparative and Named Real Case Studies - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Comparative and Named Real Case Studies

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Case method: mechanism, evidence, limitation and transfer

2 Whistleblowers and parliamentary conduct: courage plus institutional response

3 International models: prevention, deterrence, culture and attribution

4 Civil society, research ethics, workplace safety and rights jurisprudence

5 Prelims facts: dates, institutions, figures and legal status

6 Close-option traps: precedent, interim order, guideline, statute and inference

7 PYQ application: compare named evidence instead of decorating answers

8 Mains analysis: causal mechanisms, trade-offs and selective adaptation

9 Probable questions and examiner-ready comparative routes

10 Study links, historical PYQs and the qualified rule-case answer spine

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Comparative and Named Real Case Studies - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Ethics **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Generation:** learner-v2:g1 **Ownership:** GS-IV Ethics topic; recent official-paper questions retain their exact year, paper and source note. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; solved practice before optional Advanced depth; consolidated register notes last.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS ANCHOR

Current official anchor: protection status, current penalties and comparative outcomes

- FACT: Fact: Lok Sabha Unstarred Question 628, answered 3 December 2025, stated that the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 had not been brought into force and described the 2015 amendment bill as lapsed; the answer also identified the PIDPI Resolution route.
- FACT: Fact: Singapore CPIB's current PCA page states a maximum fine of S\$100,000 or imprisonment up to five years or both per corruption count, rising to seven years where the transaction concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- FACT: Fact: Transparency International's CPI 2025 data place Finland at 88 and rank 2, and Thailand at 33 and rank 116, among 182 countries.
- FACT: Fact: The Supreme Court's official 8 April 2021 Mohammad Salimullah order disposed of the interim application by declining release and a restraint on deportation, while requiring deportation to follow the prescribed procedure.

ANALYSIS: Inference / administrative link: These anchors update four distinct comparisons. The protection statute's non-commencement keeps the Manjunath-Dubey institutional gap live. Singapore requires current penalty figures rather than the ARC's historical amount. Finland and Thailand caution that integrity cannot be inferred from penalty severity alone. Salimullah must be used as an interim-order authority and paired with NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh, not converted into a final universal rule about refugees.

ANALYSIS: Limit: CPI is a perception index and does not prove the causal effect of one law. Cross-country rankings cannot be transplanted without institutional context. The accessible official Salimullah order verifies the interim application's disposal and reasoning, but this data module does not claim a later final disposal of the underlying writ petition. Korea's family and recommender extension remains an ARC-attributed claim without independent corroboration.

Official source links:

- https://www.sansad.in/getFile/loksabhaquestions/annex/186/AU628_LKQJPI.pdf?source=pqals
- https://dopt.gov.in/sites/default/files/TheWhistleBlowersProtectionAct2011_2.pdf
- <https://www.cpiib.gov.sg/about-corruption/legislation-and-enforcement/prevention-of-corruption-act/>
- <https://sso.agc.gov.sg/Act/PCA1960>
- <https://www.icac.org.hk/en/about/struct/index.html>
- <https://www.icac.org.hk/symposium/2006/exhibition/p02.pdf>
- <https://www.transparency.org/en/cpi/2025>
- <https://www.transparency.org/en/countries/finland>
- <https://www.transparency.org/en/countries/thailand>
- <https://korruptiontorjunta.fi/en/national-legislation>
- <https://www.nacc.go.th/categorydetail/2019122712514151207005112EK12853/82f4a840959a42793e58377b270540ea>
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/18898>
- https://ethics.ncdirindia.org/asset/pdf/ICMR_National_Ethical_Guidelines.pdf
- https://api.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2017/27338/27338_2017_31_1502_27493_Judgement_08-Apr-2021.pdf
- <https://api.sci.gov.in/jonew/judis/13856.pdf>

- <https://api.sci.gov.in/jonew/judis/14580.pdf>

Source caution: Topic 23 owns the disciplined use of named evidence, not the complete law of every domain it touches. The 2nd ARC's Ethics in Governance report controls its accounts of Manjunath Shanmugam, Satyendra Dubey, H.G. Mudgal, cash-for-questions, MKSS Jan Sunwai, Parivartan, Gyandoot, Bhoomi, CARD and the comparative annexure. Manjunath and Dubey must establish the protection mechanism and unresolved gap, not a heroic narrative. Mudgal and cash-for-questions establish reactive parliamentary corrective capacity, not proof of preventive detection. MKSS and Parivartan work through documentary access plus public or beneficiary verification; a social-audit finding is evidence for action, not conviction. Bhoomi must be compared with CARD through process redesign and discretion, not technology branding. Singapore's ARC-era figures are historical; current penalties must follow CPIB or Singapore Statutes Online. The Korea family and recommender claim is attributed to the ARC annexure because independent corroboration was not found. CPI 2025 figures are comparative perception data, not causal proof. Vishaka was binding interim judicial law until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute now supplies the formal process, whose practical impartiality must still be tested. ICMR's 2017 research guidance supplies consent, vulnerability and Ethics Committee standards but is not one central criminal code. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh confirms Article 21 protection for every person without creating an automatic right to remain. Mohammad Salimullah is an interim order of 8 April 2021 declining the requested restraint subject to lawful procedure; do not describe it as a final settlement of every non-refoulement argument. Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiry materials are retrospective accountability evidence, not substitutes for real-time prevention. D.K. Basu safeguards are procedural duties independent of ultimate guilt; current statutory numbering should be checked under the BNSS before use. Official local UPSC PDFs control PYQ wording. Condensed case-study entries are neutral routing where stated and do not pretend to reproduce every printed fact. A named case should always be written through rule, mechanism, application, remedy and limitation.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - Case method: mechanism, evidence, limitation and transfer

Subject: Ethics | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-IV. **Core area:** Named, source-grounded Indian cases and comparative international anti-corruption models, retaining exact source and date rather than simplified "hero stories." **Grounded in:** 2nd ARC 4th Report *Ethics in Governance* (2007) - Box 3.1 (whistleblowers), paras 2.5.7.1-2.5.7.3 (Mudgal, cash-for-questions), 5.1.3-5.1.4 (MKSS, Parivartan), 6.4.2-6.4.4 (Gyandoot, Bhoomi, CARD), 5.1.2 and National Colloquium Annexure-I(2) (Hong Kong ICAC, Singapore, Korea, Thailand, Finland, Japan); audited GS-IV PYQs; and, as cross-domain named evidence supporting 22's Sec. 14 domain modules - Vishaka & Ors v. State of Rajasthan (1997) 6 SCC 241; the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act, 2013; ICMR National Ethical Guidelines for Biomedical and Health Research Involving Human Participants (2017); NHRC v. State of Arunachal Pradesh (1996) 1 SCC 742; Mohammad Salimullah v. Union of India (2021); the 1989 Bhagalpur violence Commission of Inquiry; the Nanavati Commission (constituted 2000); and D.K. Basu v. State of West Bengal, (1997) 1 SCC 416. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/23_Comparative-and-Named-Real-Case-Studies.md.

1. Visual foundation

NAMED INDIAN CASES

Whistleblowers: Manjunath Shanmugam (IOC, killed 19 Nov 2005), Satyendra Dubey (NHAI, killed 27 Nov 2003)
 Parliamentary conduct: H.G. Mudgal (1951, expelled); "cash-for-questions" (2005, 10 Lok Sabha + 1 Rajya Sabha Members expelled)
 Civil-society/RTI: MKSS Jan Sunwai (Rajasthan); Parivartan (Delhi, PDS/RTI)
 Systemic/e-governance: Gyandoot (MP), Bhoomi (Karnataka), CARD (Andhra Pradesh - mixed results)

COMPARATIVE INTERNATIONAL MODELS

Hong Kong: ICAC (1974; law enforcement + corruption prevention + community education, Box 5.1)
 Singapore: Prevention of Corruption Act 1960 + CDSA 1992 confiscation regime (CPIB enforcement)
 Korea: 1975 General Administrative Reform Movement (dismissal + re-employment restrictions; wider family/recommender claim uncorroborated)
 Finland: least corrupt (CPI 2025 rank 2) with no separate anti-corruption statute

Core proposition: ANALYSIS: The ARC deliberately pairs *success* cases (MKSS, Parivartan, Bhoomi, Gyandoot, Hong Kong's ICAC) with *sobering* cases (Manjunath, Dubey's deaths; CARD's non-result) - a mature GS-IV answer must retain this same balance, not collapse the record into a simplified "technology/civil-society always wins" hero narrative.

SESSION 2 - Whistleblowers and parliamentary conduct: courage plus institutional response

2. Essential case summaries (retain source and date)

Case	Source-grounded facts
FACT: Manjunath Shanmugam	IIM-Lucknow graduate, Indian Oil Corporation officer; resisted bribes and threats in his fight against petrol-pump adulteration; shot dead 19 November 2005, allegedly at the behest of corrupt petrol-pump owners (ARC Box 3.1).
FACT: Satyendra Dubey	National Highways Authority of India engineer; exposed rampant corruption in road construction; found dead 27 November 2003 (ARC Box 3.1).
FACT: H.G. Mudgal case (1951)	Ad hoc Parliamentary Committee found Mudgal guilty of accepting money/benefits from the Bombay Bullion Association for parliamentary favours; PM Nehru argued the case was unambiguous and moved for expulsion, which the House accepted (ARC 2.5.7.1).
FACT: "Cash-for-questions" case (2005)	Following an "Aaj Tak" telecast of 12 December 2005 alleging acceptance of money by ten Members of the Lok Sabha for asking questions or raising matters in the House, a Lok Sabha Enquiry Committee found their conduct "unbecoming of a Member of Parliament and also unethical" and recommended expulsion, which the House accepted (ARC 2.5.7.2). The Rajya Sabha Chairman separately referred the case of one Member of that House to its Ethics Committee, which found a contravention of para 5 of the Rajya Sabha Code of Conduct and recommended expulsion, accepted by the House (ARC 2.5.7.3) - eleven expulsions in all.
FACT: MKSS Jan Sunwai (Rajasthan)	The Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan gained access to employment rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion/utilisation certificates and handed them to villagers for scrutiny in public hearings (<i>Jan Sunwai</i>), exposing false muster rolls, false bills and vouchers and false completion certificates; this led Rajasthan to create a ward sabha empowered to conduct social audit of government programmes, approve public-works proposals and certify proper execution (ARC 5.1.4).

Case	Source-grounded facts
FACT: Parivartan (Delhi)	Used the Right to Information law to insist on access to stock registers maintained by fair-price shops, exposing that large quantities of rice, wheat and oil intended for the public had been diverted to the open market (ARC 5.1.4).
FACT: Gyandoot (Madhya Pradesh)	Low-cost intranet linking market centres and villages; local youth ran kiosks on commercial lines, providing agricultural auction rates, land-record copies, online application registration, grievance redress and social-security beneficiary information; the entire project cost was borne by panchayats and the local community, averaging about Rs 75,000 per village; evaluation showed the three most-used services accounted for 95% of usage and that opportunities for corruption were greatly reduced (ARC 6.4.2).
FACT: Bhoomi (Karnataka)	Computerised 20 million land-ownership records of 6.7 million farmers; an RTC extract costs Rs 15 at computerised kiosks in 177 offices; on a mutation the computer automatically generates notices and a field revenue inspector approves the change after thirty days if no objection is received; an independent evaluation in 2002 showed significant efficiency gains and reduced corruption (ARC 6.4.3).
FACT: CARD (Andhra Pradesh)	Computer-Aided Administration of Registration Department; ARC cites a specific evaluation (Ramanathan and Balakrishnan, 2000) finding no significant difference in corruption levels between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices - a sobering counter-example to Bhoomi/Gyandoot (ARC 6.4.4).

SESSION 3 - International models: prevention, deterrence, culture and attribution

3. Comparative international models (ARC-cited)

Country/Model	Source-grounded facts
FACT: Hong Kong's ICAC	The Independent Commission Against Corruption, established in February 1974 under the ICAC Ordinance, works through an officially three-pronged strategy - law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education - delivered by its Operations, Corruption Prevention and Community Relations departments, including school programmes, community outreach and its own long-running television drama series <i>ICAC Investigators</i> ; the ARC (Box 5.1 and Annexure-I(2)) credits it with transforming a "passive social environment" that once condoned corruption.
FACT: Singapore	The ARC's 2007 annexure described the then regime as up to 5 years' imprisonment and a S\$10,000 fine, plus repayment and confiscation mechanisms. This is historical source material, not the current penalty. CURRENT: Under the Prevention of Corruption Act 1960 as it now stands, sections 5 and 6 carry a fine up to S\$100,000 or imprisonment up to 5 years, or both , per charge, rising to 7 years' imprisonment under section 7 where the matter concerns a contract with the Government or a public body. ANALYSIS: The Corruption (Confiscation of Benefits) Act 1989 that the ARC cites was repealed on 13 September 1999 ; confiscation now operates under the Corruption, Drug Trafficking and Other Serious Crimes (Confiscation of Benefits) Act 1992. Enforcement rests with the Corrupt Practices Investigation Bureau (CPIB), Singapore's sole corruption-investigation agency, covering both public and private sectors.

Country/Model	Source-grounded facts
ANALYSIS: Korea	ARC's Colloquium annexure (Annexure-I(2)) states that Korea's General Administrative Reform Movement of 1975 prohibited private-sector re-employment of civil servants dismissed for corruption, and extended the prohibition to the dismissed official's sons and grandsons and to whoever had recommended him. The existence of the 1975 movement and of re-employment restrictions is corroborated by an IMF working paper; the family and recommender extension is not independently corroborated and should be presented as the ARC's account, not as established fact. CURRENT: Korea's present framework rests on the Act on the Prevention of Corruption and the Establishment and Management of the Anti-Corruption and Civil Rights Commission (ACRC) and the Improper Solicitation and Graft Act, 2015 (the "Kim Young-ran Act").
FACT: Finland	Cited by the ARC (Annexure VIII, "Honesty in Finland") as the least-corrupt nation on the Transparency International Corruption Perceptions Index at the time of writing. CURRENT: Finland scored 88/100 and ranked 2nd of 182 in CPI 2025. ANALYSIS: The precise claim is that Finland has no separate statute specifically governing anti-corruption measures or defining the forms of corruption - its own official anti-corruption portal says so - <i>not</i> that Finland lacks corruption offences: bribery is criminalised through the Criminal Code. The lesson is that institutional culture and rule-of-law strength matter more than definitional drafting.
ANALYSIS: Thailand	ARC's Colloquium annexure notes that Thailand provides very high penalties for corruption yet "figures among countries with the highest level of corruption". CURRENT: Precision matters: the Organic Act on Anti-Corruption B.E. 2561 (2018) prescribes five to twenty years' imprisonment or life, plus fine, for the specified bribery offences - not death; the death penalty appears as an alternative punishment in specified Penal Code provisions on official and judicial bribe-taking (ss.149, 201, 202). Thailand scored 33/100 and ranked 116th of 182 in CPI 2025.
FACT: Japan	Social disapproval (informal, cultural) rather than only legal sanction is described as a principal historical mechanism regulating civil-servant conduct, with senior officials/Ministers also bearing reputational consequences for subordinates' misconduct (ARC National Colloquium Annexure-I(2)).

SESSION 4 - Civil society, research ethics, workplace safety and rights jurisprudence

4. Cross-domain named evidence supporting the Basic 22 domain modules

Core proposition: ANALYSIS: The domain modules in 22's Sec. 14 (procurement, whistleblowing, communal peace, clinical research, refugee protection, workplace harassment, environment, corporate AI) each rest on a specific named instrument or judgment, not a general impression - this section is the source bank for those modules, retaining precise citation, date and limitation exactly as Sec. 2-3 of this file already do for the anti-corruption cases above. It supplements, rather than replaces, this file's existing named-case core.

4.1 Workplace-safety and research-ethics named evidence

Instrument/case	Source-grounded facts	Limitation
FACT: Vishaka & Ors v. State of Rajasthan (1997)	(1997) 6 SCC 241; AIR 1997 SC 3011; decided 13 August 1997 by a bench of CJI J.S. Verma, Justice Sujata V. Manohar and Justice B.N. Kirpal. Laid down the first binding judicial guidelines (the "Vishaka Guidelines") requiring employers to prevent, prohibit and redress workplace sexual harassment, treating it as a violation of Articles 14, 15, 19(1)(g) and 21.	ANALYSIS: The guidelines were interim, judicially framed directions "until legislation is enacted" - not a permanent statutory code in themselves - and remained the operative law for sixteen years until Parliament finally legislated.
FACT: Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013	Converted the Vishaka Guidelines into statute: mandates an Internal Committee (IC) in any workplace with ten or more employees - at least half its members women, one external member from a women's-cause NGO/body - a written complaint within three months (extendable by three more), inquiry completion within ninety days, and employer action on the IC's recommendation within sixty days. ANALYSIS: Section 4(1)'s own text is not internally uniform: it names the body the "Internal Complaints Committee" when constituting it at the principal/administrative-unit level, then refers to the same body as the "Internal Committee" in the proviso covering offices/units at other locations - both denote one statutory body; "IC" is used here as the consistent short form.	ANALYSIS: The Act supplies the mandatory process; effective redress still depends on the specific IC's composition actually being impartial in practice - 22 Sec. 14.6 works through a case where the presiding officer is personally compromised, which the statute alone does not prevent.
FACT: ICMR National Ethical Guidelines for Biomedical and Health Research Involving Human Participants (2017)	Require a documented, comprehensible informed-consent process (Section 2.2) and additional, specific safeguards for vulnerable participants - children, pregnant women, prisoners, persons with cognitive impairment, and the economically/socially disadvantaged (Section 2.9) - with continuing oversight by an Institutional Ethics Committee (IEC), including full and undistorted reporting of trial data to that committee.	ANALYSIS: These are ethical-review guidelines administered through each institution's own IEC, not a single central regulator with uniform enforcement power across every research site - their real-world strength depends on the rigour of the specific IEC involved, the tension 22 Sec. 14.4 works through.

4.2 Humanitarian and refugee-protection jurisprudence

Case	Source-grounded facts	Limitation
FACT: NHRC v. State of Arunachal Pradesh (1996)	(1996) 1 SCC 742; AIR 1996 SC 1234; decided 9 January 1996. The Supreme Court held that Article 21 (right to life and personal liberty) protects every person in India, not only citizens, and directed the State of Arunachal Pradesh to protect Chakma/Hajong refugees from threatened eviction and violence and to forward their citizenship applications without obstruction - citing its own earlier holding in <i>Louis De Raedt v. Union of India</i> (1991) that even foreign nationals enjoy Article 21 protection.	ANALYSIS: The judgment protects life/liberty and due process for non-citizens; it does not create a general right to remain in, or not be removed from, India - a distinction made explicit twenty-five years later in <i>Mohammad Salimullah</i> .
FACT: Mohammad Salimullah v. Union of India (2021)	An interim order of the Supreme Court dated 8 April 2021, declining an interim stay on the deportation of a specific group of detained Rohingya individuals - not a final judgment disposing of the writ petition on merits. ANALYSIS: In declining interim relief, the Court observed/reasoned , without a full trial of the underlying constitutional question, that the right not to be deported is tied to Article 19(1)(e) (right to reside/settle), which applies only to citizens, and that India - not being a signatory to the 1951 Refugee Convention or its 1967 Protocol - is not thereby bound to a domestic non-refoulement obligation; on that reasoning, deportation could proceed if the ordinary procedure under the Foreigners Act, 1946 was followed. The underlying petition remained pending after this order.	ANALYSIS: This is an interim-order refusal with observations, not a final holding that conclusively settles the customary-international-law question. The substantive legal debate remains open and is explicitly <i>not</i> resolved by this order: whether non-refoulement binds India as customary international law independent of treaty ratification was raised by the petitioners and was not definitively adjudicated - legal scholars have criticised the order for declining interim relief without fully engaging that argument. India also has no dedicated refugee statute, so protection for genuine asylum-seekers remains ad hoc and case-by-case, not a codified legal entitlement. A case-study or Mains answer should present this as the Court's interim reasoning on an unresolved question, not as a settled final precedent foreclosing the customary-law argument.
ANALYSIS: Reading the two cases together (as 22 Sec. 14.5 applies them)	Article 14/21 due-process and dignity protections apply to every person on Indian soil regardless of citizenship (<i>Arunachal Pradesh</i> , a final judgment), while <i>Salimullah's</i> interim reasoning declines to treat Article 19(1)(e) or non-refoulement as available to non-citizens absent specific protection - with the customary-international-law question left open.	A case-study answer must hold both propositions simultaneously and flag <i>Salimullah's</i> interim status explicitly - neither an "automatic protection," an "automatic deportation," nor a claim that the non-refoulement debate is judicially closed is source-accurate.

4.3 Communal-harmony and peacebuilding named evidence

Case/practice	Source-grounded facts	Limitation
FACT: 1989 Bhagalpur violence	Communal violence in Bhagalpur, Bihar (October-November 1989) killed over a thousand people; a Commission of Inquiry examined the causes and the administrative/police response, finding that rumour, prior communal tension, and failures of local administration and policing (including allowing a provocative procession through a sensitive area) were central contributing factors.	ANALYSIS: The Commission's report took years to complete - illustrating that a formal inquiry is a post-facto accountability tool, not a preventive one. A case-study answer should not present a commission of inquiry as a substitute for real-time, proportionate administrative action of the kind modelled in 22 Sec. 14.3.
FACT: Nanavati Commission (constituted 2000)	A Commission of Inquiry under Justice G.T. Nanavati was constituted in 2000 to re-examine the 1984 anti-Sikh riots - the sequence of events, and lapses in administrative/police response. Its report found evidence implicating some political actors and criticised police inaction, but was also criticised for cautious, non-definitive findings on individual culpability.	ANALYSIS: As with Bhagalpur, this illustrates a commission's real but limited role - retrospective fact-finding and recommendation, not real-time crisis management; do not conflate the two functions in an answer.
ANALYSIS: District-level peace/harmony committees (general administrative practice)	Many Indian states maintain standing local peace/harmony committees - bringing together police, district administration and representative community leaders - as a preventive, dialogue-based mechanism intended to defuse tension before it escalates, distinct from the post-facto inquiry-commission mechanism above.	This is a general, widely documented administrative practice rather than a single named all-India statute; verify the specific committee/order relevant to a given state before citing it as a uniform, nationwide legal requirement.

4.4 Custodial-justice/policing jurisprudence

Case	Source-grounded facts	Limitation
FACT: D.K. Basu v. State of West Bengal (1997)	(1997) 1 SCC 416; decided 18 December 1996 by a bench of Kuldeep Singh and Dr A.S. Anand JJ, on a letter treated as a writ petition regarding custodial deaths. Laid down eleven specific procedural safeguards on arrest and detention - including a witnessed, countersigned arrest memo; the right to have a friend/relative/well-wisher informed of the arrest and place of custody; medical examination at the time of arrest and at approximately 48-hour intervals thereafter, with injuries recorded; entries in a case diary/custody register; and information to the jurisdictional magistrate - as flowing from Articles 21 and 22.	ANALYSIS: These guidelines were given statutory backing through Cr.P.C. amendments (notably the 2008/2010 insertions on arrest procedure, medical examination and the right to inform a relative); with the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 replacing the Cr.P.C. from 1 July 2024, the equivalent provisions now sit under BNSS's renumbered sections - verify the current section numbers before citing them in a live answer rather than assuming the old Cr.P.C. numbering still applies.

- ANALYSIS: **Use in a case-study answer:** 22 Sec. 14.12 applies these safeguards to a worked custodial-excess case - cite the safeguards as *procedural* obligations owed regardless of the eventual finding on whether force used was actually excessive, since skipping them is itself a breach independent of that separate factual question.

SESSION 5 - Prelims facts: dates, institutions, figures and legal status

5. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: Satyendra Dubey (NHAI) died 27 November 2003; Manjunath Shanmugam (IOC) died 19 November 2005 - both cited by the ARC as the direct human cost motivating its whistleblower-protection recommendation.
- FACT: The Mudgal case (1951) was independent India's first major parliamentary-expulsion precedent for corrupt conduct; the 2005 "cash-for-questions" case saw **ten Lok Sabha Members and one Rajya Sabha Member** expelled.
- FACT: ARC's own CARD citation is the source-grounded counter-example showing computerisation alone does not guarantee reduced corruption - contrast this explicitly with Bhoomi and Gyandoot.
- ANALYSIS: Finland (ranked 2nd, 88/100, in CPI 2025) has no separate anti-corruption statute or statutory definition of corruption, but does criminalise bribery through its Criminal Code - the correct formulation of an often-mangled fact.
- FACT: The Vishaka Guidelines (1997) operated as interim judicial law for sixteen years before the POSH Act, 2013 codified them; the ICMR's 2017 guidelines govern informed consent and vulnerable- participant safeguards through each institution's own Ethics Committee, not a single central body.
- FACT: India is not a signatory to the 1951 Refugee Convention or its 1967 Protocol; the Supreme Court in *Mohammad Salimullah* (2021), **in an interim order declining a stay on deportation** (not a final judgment), reasoned this means no binding domestic non-refoulement obligation follows from Article 19(1)(e) - leaving the separate customary-international-law non-refoulement argument an open legal question - even though *NHRC v. State of Arunachal Pradesh* (1996), a final judgment, confirms Article 21 due-process protection for every person, citizen or not.
- FACT: *D.K. Basu v. State of West Bengal* (1997), decided 18 December 1996, laid down eleven procedural safeguards on arrest/custody as flowing from Articles 21 and 22, later given statutory backing through Cr.P.C. amendments and now carried forward under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023.

SESSION 6 - Close-option traps: precedent, interim order, guideline, statute and inference

6. UPSC traps

- WRONG: All IT-enabled governance reforms reduce corruption. -> ARC's own CARD citation shows a specific, source-grounded counter-example; always pair a success case with this sobering contrast.
- WRONG: Whistleblower cases like Manjunath and Dubey led to immediate comprehensive legal protection. -> The Whistle Blowers Protection Act was enacted only in 2014 (assent 9 May 2014) and has never been brought into force; the 2015 Amendment Bill lapsed (see 10, 19).
- WRONG: Harsher penalties always produce lower corruption (Thailand's severe punishments prove this). -> ARC's own citation shows Thailand had severe penalties yet high corruption, and it still scores 33/100 (rank 116 of 182) in CPI 2025 - the two variables are not simply, directly correlated. ANALYSIS: Also state the penalty precisely: the 2018 Organic Act prescribes five to twenty years or life, while the death penalty appears only in specified Penal Code bribe-taking provisions.

SESSION 7 - PYQ application: compare named evidence instead of decorating answers

7. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Any question on "civil society's role in fighting corruption" should cite MKSS and Parivartan by name with their specific mechanisms (Jan Sunwai; RTI-enabled PDS stock-register access).
- ANALYSIS: Any question on "e-governance and corruption" should cite Gyandoot/Bhoomi as successes and CARD

as the ARC's own cited counter-example, to demonstrate balanced, source-grounded analysis.

- ANALYSIS: Any comparative-institutions question should cite Hong Kong's ICAC (attitude-change model), Singapore's CPIB (penalty + confiscation model), and Korea's 1975 reform (family/recommender liability model) as three genuinely distinct anti-corruption design philosophies.
- ANALYSIS: Any case-study question on workplace harassment, clinical-research ethics, or cross-border/refugee protection should cite the specific instrument or judgment in Sec. 4 (Vishaka/POSH Act; ICMR 2017 guidelines; *NHRC v. Arunachal Pradesh/Mohammad Salimullah*) rather than a generic "there are laws for this" statement - see the worked applications in 22 Sec. 14.4-14.6 and 14.5.

SESSION 8 - Mains analysis: causal mechanisms, trade-offs and selective adaptation

8. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Never present a named case as a simplified "hero wins" story - always retain the case's precise source, date and (where the ARC itself notes it) limitation or mixed result.
- ANALYSIS: When asked for a "model" from abroad, name the specific mechanism (ICAC's public education; Singapore's confiscation law; Korea's extended-family employment ban) rather than a vague "that country is less corrupt" statement.
- ANALYSIS: The same discipline applies to Sec. 4's named evidence: cite Vishaka's precise 1997 date and its sixteen-year interim status before the 2013 Act, and hold both *Arunachal Pradesh* and *Salimullah* together rather than citing either case alone to imply an absolute position on refugee rights - and state *Salimullah* precisely as an interim order declining a stay, with the customary-international-law non-refoulement question left open, not as a final holding.

Answer thesis: India's and the world's anti-corruption record, as the ARC itself documents, is a mixed one of genuine successes (MKSS, Parivartan, Bhoomi, Gyandoot, Hong Kong's ICAC) and sobering limitations (Manjunath's and Dubey's deaths, CARD's non-result, Thailand's severe- penalty/high-corruption combination) - a mature answer retains this balance and precise sourcing rather than a simplified narrative.

SESSION 9 - Probable questions and examiner-ready comparative routes

9. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** In which year were Satyendra Dubey and Manjunath Shanmugam killed, respectively?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** What does the CARD case in Andhra Pradesh teach about the limits of IT-enabled anti-corruption reform?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Compare Hong Kong's ICAC, Singapore's CPIB and Korea's 1975 reform as three distinct anti-corruption institutional-design philosophies.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Discuss the significance of the Vishaka Guidelines (1997) and assess how far the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace Act, 2013 has addressed their limitations.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "India's constitutional protections for non-citizens do not amount to a right against deportation." Examine with reference to *NHRC v. State of Arunachal Pradesh* (1996) and *Mohammad Salimullah v. Union of India* (2021).
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Enumerate the key procedural safeguards laid down in **D.K. Basu v. State of West Bengal** (1997) and their significance for preventing custodial abuse.

SESSION 10 - Study links, historical PYQs and the qualified rule-case answer spine

10. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion: advanced/23_Comparative-and-Named-Real-Case-Studies.md.
- FACT: 19_Corruption-Legal-Framework.md - the whistleblower-protection legal status these cases motivated.
- FACT: 17_Citizens-Charters-Work-Culture-and-Service-Delivery.md - Bhoomi/Gyandoot as service-delivery models.
- FACT: 22_Case-Study-Method-and-Answer-Architecture.md - applying these real cases, and the Sec. 4 named evidence, within the eight-element case-study answer architecture (see especially Sec. 14's domain modules).

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-IV
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Semantic table split - Year

- **Year:** 2018
- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q:** 12
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** Edward Snowden released classified government surveillance documents citing moral obligation to inform public; ethically justified even if legally prohibited - weighing competing values
- **Directive / format:** Case study · 20 marks · 250 words
- **Source status:** Case routed to Ethics case-study method
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Edward Snowden released classified government surveillance documents citing moral obligation to inform public; ethically justified even if legally prohibited - weighing competing values

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

An answer praises personal courage but proposes no secure channel, anti-retaliation measure or investigation route. What essential institutional lesson is missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- B. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- C. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: A

Explanation: Manjunath and Dubey reveal an unresolved protection gap is the controlling principle. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 2

A department separates the informer's identity, assesses threats, preserves evidence and routes the allegation independently. Which case-derived mechanism is being applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- B. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- C. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- D. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.

Answer: B

Explanation: Manjunath and Dubey reveal an unresolved protection gap is the controlling principle. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 3

A candidate says the 2014 enactment immediately supplied every whistleblower with an operational statutory remedy. Which legal-status distinction defeats the claim? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- B. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: C

Explanation: The 2014 protection statute is not operational merely because enacted is the controlling principle. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 4

An answer distinguishes enacted text, commencement and the interim administrative route. Which form of legal precision does this demonstrate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- B. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- C. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- D. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.

Answer: D

Explanation: The 2014 protection statute is not operational merely because enacted is the controlling principle. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 5

A portal hides the complainant's name on screen but circulates an identifiable attachment to the accused chain. Which protection failure remains? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- B. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- C. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: A

Explanation: Confidentiality is a process, not a slogan is the controlling principle. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 6

Only a designated cell can decrypt identity data, and every access is logged and reviewable. Which practical safeguard is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- B. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- C. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- D. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Confidentiality is a process, not a slogan is the controlling principle. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 7

An agency publicly condemns an official solely because a protected complaint was filed. Which due-process error has occurred? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- B. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- C. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
- D. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.

Answer: C

Explanation: A whistleblower allegation still requires fair verification is the controlling principle. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 8

Identity protection operates alongside independent evidence testing and a fair hearing. Which balanced rule follows from the named whistleblower cases? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
- B. Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
- C. Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
- D. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.

Answer: D

Explanation: A whistleblower allegation still requires fair verification is the controlling principle. The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 9

A legislator claims parliamentary privilege prevents the House from responding to proven paid advocacy by a member. Which precedent answers the claim? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- B. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- C. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Mudgal established a parliamentary corrective precedent** is the controlling principle. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 10

The House acts on a committee's evidence and protects the integrity of representation. Which institutional capacity is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- B. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- C. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- D. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Mudgal established a parliamentary corrective precedent** is the controlling principle. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 11

An answer cites the expulsions as proof that internal ethics systems automatically detect all misconduct. Which limitation has been ignored? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- B. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- C. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: C

Explanation: Cash-for-questions confirms power but also reactivity is the controlling principle. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 12

A reform retains expulsion for proved misconduct but adds disclosure analytics and proactive ethics monitoring. Which gap is it addressing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- B. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- C. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- D. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.

Answer: D

Explanation: Cash-for-questions confirms power but also reactivity is the controlling principle. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 13

A social audit meeting gathers grievances without obtaining the underlying records. Which distinctive evidentiary element of Jan Sunwai is absent? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- B. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- C. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: A

Explanation: **MKSS Jan Sunwai converts records into public proof** is the controlling principle. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 14

Villagers compare muster-roll names with actual workers and publicly record contradictions. Which accountability mechanism is operating? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- B. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- C. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- D. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.

Answer: B

Explanation: **MKSS Jan Sunwai converts records into public proof** is the controlling principle. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 15

Residents complain of shortages but cannot inspect stock or issue records. Which information bridge would the Parivartan example recommend? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- B. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- C. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
- D. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.

Answer: C

Explanation: Parivartan made PDS diversion testable through RTI is the controlling principle. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 16

A community reconciles shop registers, beneficiary accounts and physical delivery before seeking action. Which case mechanism is replicated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
- B. MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
- C. The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
- D. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.

Answer: D

Explanation: Parivartan made PDS diversion testable through RTI is the controlling principle. Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 17

A district buys computers but citizens still require a broker to obtain every certified record. Which Gyandoot design objective remains unmet? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- B. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- C. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Gyandoot reduced costly human intermediation** is the controlling principle. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 18

Village kiosks publish service access, fees and grievance registration without repeated office visits. Which mechanism is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- B. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- C. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- D. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Gyandoot reduced costly human intermediation** is the controlling principle. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 19

An office scans records but preserves an undefined approval queue controlled by one official. Why is this unlike the strongest Bhoomi lesson? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- B. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- C. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: C

Explanation: **Bhoomi changed the mutation workflow** is the controlling principle. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 20

A mutation request automatically generates notice, deadline and auditable status. Which anti-corruption design principle is applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- B. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- C. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- D. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.

Answer: D

Explanation: **Bhoomi changed the mutation workflow** is the controlling principle. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 21

A ministry claims any database conversion necessarily lowers bribery. Which named comparison directly challenges that inference? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- B. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- C. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: A

Explanation: CARD is the necessary digital-government counter-example is the controlling principle. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 22

A project evaluation asks whether approval discretion, valuation opacity and citizen dependence actually changed. Which CARD-derived test is being used? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- B. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- C. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- D. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.

Answer: B

Explanation: CARD is the necessary digital-government counter-example is the controlling principle. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 23

Two portals use similar software but only one removes manual discretion. What variable should an ethical evaluation prioritise? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- B. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- C. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.
- D. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.

Answer: C

Explanation: Technology must be tied to the corruption mechanism is the controlling principle. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 24

A reform maps each bribery opportunity to a redesigned step and measurable citizen outcome. Which comparative lesson is followed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
- B. The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
- C. Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
- D. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

Answer: D

Explanation: Technology must be tied to the corruption mechanism is the controlling principle. Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 25

A government copies only investigative powers and omits prevention review and public education. Which part of the ICAC mechanism has been lost? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- B. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- C. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: A

Explanation: Hong Kong ICAC uses three mutually supporting prongs is the controlling principle. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 26

Investigators pursue offences while specialists redesign procedures and educators build public resistance to bribery. Which model is represented? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- B. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- C. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- D. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.

Answer: B

Explanation: Hong Kong ICAC uses three mutually supporting prongs is the controlling principle. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 27

An answer repeats the lower fine printed in the ARC's 2007 annexure as present law. Which source-handling error has occurred? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- B. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- C. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: C

Explanation: Singapore penalties must use current official figures is the controlling principle. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 28

A candidate dates the ARC figure, then cites CPIB's current maximum separately. Which comparative practice is correct? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- B. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- C. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- D. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.

Answer: D

Explanation: Singapore penalties must use current official figures is the controlling principle. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 29

A student states that modern Korean law automatically punishes an offender's grandchildren. Which evidentiary caveat is missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- B. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- C. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: A

Explanation: Korea's wider liability claim requires attribution is the controlling principle. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 30

An essay uses the claim hypothetically, identifies its ARC attribution and examines individual fairness. Which disciplined use is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- B. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- C. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- D. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.

Answer: B

Explanation: Korea's wider liability claim requires attribution is the controlling principle. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 31

A proposal assumes harsher punishment mechanically produces a cleaner administration. Which current comparison supplies a caution? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- B. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- C. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- D. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.

Answer: C

Explanation: Finland and Thailand defeat single-lever explanations is the controlling principle. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 32

An answer links sanctions with rule of law, enforcement, transparency and culture. Which multi-causal conclusion follows? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- B. The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- C. Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- D. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.

Answer: D

Explanation: Finland and Thailand defeat single-lever explanations is the controlling principle. CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 33

An employer in 2005 argues that no duty existed because Parliament had not legislated. Which judicial mechanism defeats the claim? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- B. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- C. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: A

Explanation: Vishaka was binding interim judicial law is the controlling principle. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 34

A present answer cites the 2013 statute while using Vishaka for its constitutional foundation. Which historical sequence is correct? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- B. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- C. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- D. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.

Answer: B

Explanation: Vishaka was binding interim judicial law is the controlling principle. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 35

The presiding officer is the respondent's direct business partner but refuses recusal because the committee exists by law. Which limitation is exposed? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- B. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- C. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: C

Explanation: A statutory committee is not automatically impartial is the controlling principle. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 36

An alternate unconflicted process preserves the complainant's safety and the respondent's hearing. Which rule-case balance is achieved? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- B. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- C. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- D. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.

Answer: D

Explanation: A statutory committee is not automatically impartial is the controlling principle. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 37

A poor participant signs a technical form after being told treatment depends on joining. Which research-ethics defects remain? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- B. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- C. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: A

Explanation: ICMR ethics makes consent an ongoing protection is the controlling principle. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 38

The committee reviews recruitment pressure, translated information, withdrawal rights and adverse events. Which ethical framework is operating? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- B. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- C. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- D. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.

Answer: B

Explanation: ICMR ethics makes consent an ongoing protection is the controlling principle. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 39

A committee routinely approves sponsor submissions without reading adverse-event data. Which implementation limitation is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- B. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- C. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- D. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.

Answer: C

Explanation: **Guidelines depend on institutional enforcement quality** is the controlling principle. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 40

Independent members demand complete safety data and suspend recruitment pending clarification. Which oversight responsibility is fulfilled? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- B. The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- C. Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- D. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.

Answer: D

Explanation: **Guidelines depend on institutional enforcement quality** is the controlling principle. ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 41

A mob threatens non-citizens while officials treat nationality as a reason for inaction. Which constitutional precedent requires protection? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- B. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- C. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: A

Explanation: **NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh protects every person's life** is the controlling principle. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 42

Police prevent violence and authorities process claims lawfully without promising permanent residence. Which precise duty is respected? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- B. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- C. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- D. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.

Answer: B

Explanation: **NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh protects every person's life** is the controlling principle. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 43

An answer calls the interim order a final universal rejection of refugee protection. Which precedential overstatement is present? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- B. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- C. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: C

Explanation: Salimullah is an interim-order authority with limits is the controlling principle. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 44

A decision protects Article 21 process while separately examining lawful removal authority. Which paired reading with NHRC is appropriate? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- B. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- C. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- D. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.

Answer: D

Explanation: Salimullah is an interim-order authority with limits is the controlling principle. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 45

A district delays preventive action because a future commission can investigate later. Which mechanism limitation has been misunderstood? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- B. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- C. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: A

Explanation: Bhagalpur and Nanavati are retrospective accountability tools is the controlling principle. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 46

Administration acts immediately, preserves records and later cooperates with independent inquiry. Which complementary design is shown? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- B. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- C. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- D. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.

Answer: B

Explanation: Bhagalpur and Nanavati are retrospective accountability tools is the controlling principle. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 47

Police omit the arrest memo because they consider the suspect obviously guilty. Which constitutional error does the precedent expose? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- B. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- C. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.
- D. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.

Answer: C

Explanation: D.K. Basu safeguards operate before guilt is known is the controlling principle. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 48

Officers document custody and medical condition while continuing a lawful investigation. Which rule-case mechanism is applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- B. The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- C. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- D. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

Answer: D

Explanation: D.K. Basu safeguards operate before guilt is known is the controlling principle. D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 - 20 marks

Question: GS-IV Q12: Edward Snowden, a computer expert and former CIA systems administrator, released confidential Government documents to the press about Government surveillance programmes. Do you agree that Snowden's actions were ethically justified even if legally prohibited? Why or why not? Make an argument by weighing the competing values in this case. (250 words)

Source / ownership: Faithful condensed routing verified against books\more_previous_papers\GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER-IV.pdf, page 11. The official printed stem is longer and controls exact wording; this entry preserves its actor, act, demand and word limit.

Model solution

Snowden's disclosure can be ethically defended only through a necessity and proportionality test. The public-interest claim is that secret mass surveillance affects privacy, autonomy and democratic consent. Satyendra Dubey and Manjunath Shanmugam similarly show why internal wrongdoing may require protected escalation when ordinary hierarchy is implicated. Their cases prove the need for voice, not an unlimited licence to disclose every secret.

Competing values are national security, confidentiality, lawful office, institutional trust and possible harm to operations or persons. A responsible whistleblower should first test whether an independent authorised channel is safe and effective, authenticate evidence, minimise unrelated disclosure and choose the least harmful route. MKSS offers the opposite context: official records were publicly cross-verified because community scrutiny was the accountability mechanism; intelligence material demands narrower handling.

Therefore legality is morally relevant but not conclusive. Disclosure is strongest where wrongdoing is serious, internal remedies are captured or futile, evidence is reliable, public benefit is high and avoidable harm is minimised. It is weakest where mass release is indiscriminate. The cases support protected, proportionate truth-telling plus independent review, not either blind secrecy or heroic law-breaking as an automatic rule.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 - 10 marks

Question: "Non-performance of duty by a public servant is a form of corruption". Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer. (150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-GeneralStudies-IV.pdf, page 2.

Model solution

I agree when non-performance is a deliberate misuse of entrusted power for private benefit, protection of allies or foreseeable public harm. Satyendra Dubey's road-contract disclosures show how official inaction toward credible corruption can enable systemic loss. Parivartan likewise showed that failure to reconcile PDS stock records allowed diversion to persist.

But every shortfall is not corrupt. CARD's limited anti-corruption result warns that poor system design may preserve discretion even when individual staff operate the new technology. Capacity shortage, legal ambiguity, negligence and bona fide error require different diagnoses.

The test should identify a clear duty, knowledge, ability to act, motive, benefit, harm and evidence. Wilful omission for improper advantage is corrupt; inability or reasonable error is not. Fair inquiry protects both accountability and honest administration.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 - 10 marks

Question: What do you understand by probity in governance? Based on your understanding of the term, suggest measures for ensuring probity in government. (150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-GeneralStudies-IV.pdf, page 3.

Model solution

Probity is demonstrable integrity in public power: legality, impartiality, transparent reasons, answerability and fidelity to public purpose. It must be designed into systems. MKSS Jan Sunwai made probity testable by comparing public records with community evidence. Bhoomi reduced routine gatekeeping through automatic notices and deadlines, whereas CARD warns that digitisation without process redesign may leave corruption unchanged.

Government should publish criteria and records, protect whistleblowers, disclose conflicts, conduct independent social audit, reduce monopoly discretion and ensure time-bound remedies. Parliamentary ethics systems should learn from Mudgal and cash-for-questions by adding proactive monitoring to their proven corrective power.

Hong Kong's ICAC adds a useful synthesis: enforcement, prevention and community education should reinforce one another. Probity is sustained when ethical culture, auditable process and fair consequence operate together.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 - 10 marks

Question: An independent and empowered social audit mechanism is an absolute must in every sphere of public service, including judiciary, to ensure performance, accountability and ethical conduct. Elaborate. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-21-GENSTUDIESPAPER-IV-110122.pdf, page 3.

Model solution

Social audit makes official performance answerable to affected people. MKSS's Jan Sunwai joined muster rolls and vouchers with public cross-verification, exposing false workers, bills and completion claims. Parivartan similarly used PDS stock registers to test whether recorded supplies reached citizens. These cases show that independence requires access to usable records, community voice, protection against retaliation and mandatory action-taken reports.

The mechanism has limits. A public hearing is not a criminal trial, and organisational capacity varies. For the judiciary, administrative expenditure, listing systems and service delivery may be audited, but the merits of judgments belong to appeal and review so decisional independence is preserved.

Thus social audit should produce verified evidence and institutional learning, then route misconduct to the competent forum. It strengthens accountability without replacing investigation or adjudication.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 - 10 marks

Question: Whistle-blower, who reports corruption and illegal activities, wrongdoing and misconduct to the concerned authorities, runs the risk of being exposed to grave danger, physical harm and victimization by vested interests, accused persons and his team. What policy measures would you suggest to strengthen protection mechanism to safeguard the whistle-blower? (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER IV-190922.pdf, page 4.

Model solution

Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey show that courage without institutional protection can become fatal. Policy should provide a secure authorised channel, identity separation, access logs, immediate threat assessment, police protection where necessary, safe transfer, service protection, compensation and punishment for retaliation. Evidence must be preserved outside the accused hierarchy and examined by an independent authority.

The legal gap must be stated precisely: a 2025 official Lok Sabha answer said the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 had not been brought into force; the PIDPI administrative mechanism remains relevant but is not an equivalent statutory shield. Time-bound acknowledgement, investigation updates and external review are therefore vital.

Protection should coexist with good-faith thresholds and fair verification. The informant is protected from retaliation; the accused is protected from allegation-based guilt.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2023 - 10 marks

Question: "Corruption is the manifestation of the failure of core values in the society." In your opinion, what measures can be adopted to uplift the core values in the society? (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against
books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-23-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER-IV-180923.pdf, page 2.

Model solution

Corruption reflects weakened honesty, fairness and public spirit, but values are reinforced or eroded by institutions. Hong Kong's ICAC combines community education with prevention and enforcement, showing that moral learning needs credible systems. Finland's CPI 2025 position, despite no single dedicated anti-corruption statute, similarly cautions against reducing integrity to punishment alone.

Families, schools, professional bodies and public leaders should reject admiration of illicit wealth, teach constitutional morality and reward public-minded conduct. Government should protect whistleblowers, publish reasons and records, reduce discretionary bottlenecks and support citizen verification such as MKSS Jan Sunwai. Thailand's severe-penalty yet weaker CPI position warns that deterrence without institutional culture is insufficient.

Core values rise when ethical conduct is socially respected, administratively feasible and fairly enforced consistently.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: The 'Code of Conduct' and 'Code of Ethics' are the sources of guidance in public administration. There is code of conduct already in operation, whereas code of ethics is not yet put in place. Suggest a suitable model for code of ethics to maintain integrity, probity and transparency in governance. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording, with punctuation normalised, verified against books\mains\05 UPSC 2024 Paper-IV_Final 1.pdf, page 4.

Model solution

A code of ethics should state public-service purposes rather than merely prohibited acts: constitutional fidelity, impartiality, truthfulness, stewardship, dignity, courage and reasoned accountability. Each value needs an operational rule. Dubey and Manjunath support protected reporting; MKSS supports public access and verification; D.K. Basu shows that dignity requires documented procedure even for unpopular persons.

The code should require conflict disclosure, written reasons, recusal, protection of personal data, fair hearing, safe consultation and refusal of unlawful directions. Training should use named comparative cases, while independent ethics advisers and annual public reporting convert aspiration into practice.

Enforcement must be proportionate and reviewable. Mudgal shows meaningful consequence for proven breach, but CARD warns that formal adoption without process change may achieve little. A living code links values, decision tests, support and fair accountability.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: In Indian culture and value system, an equal opportunity has been provided irrespective of gender identity. The number of women in public service has been steadily increasing over the years. Examine the gender-specific challenges faced by female public servants and suggest suitable measures to increase their efficiency in discharging their duties and maintaining high standards of probity. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording verified against books\mains\05 UPSC 2024 Paper-IV_Final 1.pdf, page 4.

Model solution

Female public servants may face harassment, stereotyping, unsafe postings, exclusion from informal networks, disproportionate care burdens and retaliation for reporting misconduct. These barriers impair equal opportunity and may pressure officers to tolerate unethical conduct. Vishaka located workplace safety in Articles 14, 15, 19(1)(g) and 21; the 2013 statute supplies a formal prevention and redress process.

Measures should include safe infrastructure and transport, transparent posting and promotion criteria, flexible but non-penalising work arrangements, mentoring, leadership representation and confidential reporting. Internal Committees must be properly composed, independent and free from personal conflict; their mere existence does not guarantee fairness.

As ICMR ethics shows in another domain, vulnerable-position safeguards need continuing oversight, not one-time paper compliance. Equality, safety and impartial process enable both efficiency and probity.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment but a product of civil education and adherence of the rule of law." Examine the significance of constitutional morality for public servant highlighting the role in promoting good governance and ensuring accountability in public administration. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Exact English wording, with the paper's spelling normalised, verified against books\mains\UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 4.pdf, page 2.

Model solution

Constitutional morality requires officials to exercise power through equality, dignity, liberty, reason and lawful procedure, especially when popularity points elsewhere. NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh required protection of non-citizens from violence because Article 21 covers every person. D.K. Basu similarly made custody safeguards obligatory before guilt is determined.

For good governance, this ethic demands transparent criteria, recorded reasons, hearing, recusal and review. Vishaka shows constitutional values filling a legislative vacuum, while the later workplace statute shows their translation into durable procedure. Salimullah must be cited cautiously: its 2021 interim order addressed deportation relief and lawful procedure, not every refugee-law question finally.

Thus civil education teaches the values, but institutions make them habitual. Constitutional morality restrains majoritarian impulse and official convenience while keeping accountability evidence-based and reviewable.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2022 - 20 marks

Question: Neutral routing of GS-IV Q10: an investigative journalist uncovers a stone-mining mafia involving corrupt police and civil officials and a politically connected media owner, while inducement and pressure are used to suppress publication. Evaluate the options, ethical dilemmas and appropriate response. (250 words)

Source / ownership: Neutral demand routed from books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-GENERAL-STUDIES-PAPER IV-190922.pdf, page 10. The official multi-part case stem controls its complete facts and wording.

Model solution

The journalist faces truth and public interest against personal safety, source protection, confidentiality, editorial loyalty and the risk that premature publication may destroy evidence. Manjunath and Dubey warn that exposing a profitable network without protection can invite lethal retaliation. The first duty is therefore neither silence nor reckless heroism.

He should authenticate permits, transport records, payments and communications; preserve encrypted copies in independent custody; document threats and inducements; obtain legal and trusted editorial review; and assess source-specific risk. A secure disclosure to a competent independent authority should precede or accompany carefully timed publication. Unrelated personal data and operational details should be minimised.

MKSS and Parivartan show the power of transaction-level records and public verification, but the mining network also shows their limit where police, administration, politics and media ownership are captured. Escalation may require judicial protection or another legally competent forum. Publication should explain evidence and uncertainty, not pronounce guilt.

The long-term remedy is network-focused: protect witnesses, reconcile extraction and royalty data, rotate captured posts, disclose ownership conflicts and create independent complaint routes. The qualified verdict is protected, evidence-led disclosure using the least harmful effective channel, followed by fair investigation and systemic repair.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Compare the ethical significance of Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey without reducing either case to a hero story. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Both officers demonstrate integrity and moral courage against organised wrongdoing: Manjunath challenged fuel adulteration, while Dubey exposed corruption in highway construction. Their deaths prove that individual virtue can reveal serious misconduct but cannot supply its own protection.

The institutional mechanism is therefore central: a safe authorised channel, identity separation, threat assessment, independent evidence custody, anti-retaliation remedies and time-bound investigation. The unresolved legal position matters. An official 2025 Lok Sabha answer stated that the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 had not been brought into force; PIDPI remains an administrative route, not an equivalent statutory guarantee.

The limitation is equally important: protection cannot make an allegation self-proving. Fair verification and hearing remain necessary. The cases support protected courage joined to institutional duty, not martyrdom as a governance model.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: What do the Mudgal and cash-for-questions cases establish about parliamentary ethics, and what do they fail to establish? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Mudgal in 1951 established that proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours could be treated as conduct incompatible with membership. The 2005 cash-for-questions episode confirmed that Houses could investigate clear evidence and expel ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member. Together they show meaningful institutional self-discipline and reputational protection of representative office.

They do not establish an effective preventive system. Mudgal followed a complaint, while the later expulsions followed a media sting. The mechanism was reactive and evidence-triggered; it says little about undetected conduct. Nor does expulsion replace criminal or other legal process where applicable.

Reform should preserve fair committee inquiry and decisive consequence while adding conflict disclosure, gift and interest registers, proactive pattern review and reasoned public reporting. The cases prove corrective capacity, not automatic ethical health.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare MKSS Jan Sunwai and Parivartan as civil-society accountability mechanisms. Why are they more than generic examples of activism? Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Both cases converted information rights into verifiable public claims. MKSS obtained muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates, then used Jan Sunwai to compare them with community testimony. False workers, bills and completion claims became publicly demonstrable. Parivartan obtained fair-price-shop stock registers and compared recorded grain and oil with actual PDS delivery, exposing diversion.

Their common mechanism is an evidence chain: access -> intelligible records -> affected-person verification -> public hearing or reconciliation -> reasoned demand for action. This differs from unsupported accusation and helps overcome information asymmetry. MKSS also influenced Rajasthan's ward-sabha social-audit role, showing institutional absorption.

The models have limits. They depend on organised citizens, record access, local safety and a responsive consequence forum. Public findings are not convictions, and elite or violent capture may require protected escalation. Therefore replication needs facilitation funds, open data, witness protection and mandatory action-taken reports. Their lesson is not merely that civil society is beneficial, but that documentary access plus collective verification can transform private suspicion into accountable public evidence. Periodic independent evaluation should also test inclusion, record accuracy and whether verified findings actually produce timely corrective action.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Bhoomi and CARD to explain when digital governance reduces corruption and when it merely computerises an existing problem. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Bhoomi combined record computerisation with workflow change. Kiosk access reduced dependence on intermediaries; automatic mutation notices and a defined objection period constrained routine gatekeeping and created an auditable sequence. The ARC cites a 2002 evaluation finding efficiency gains and reduced corruption.

CARD also computerised registration administration, but the ARC-cited Ramanathan and Balakrishnan evaluation found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices. The defensible comparison is not superior hardware. It is whether the reform changed valuation, approval, queue and citizen-dependence mechanisms that generated rents. Digital storage can coexist with opaque discretion.

A credible project should therefore map each corruption opportunity, automate only rule-bound steps, publish fees and deadlines, log overrides, provide appeal and test actual citizen experience. Gyandoot adds accessibility through local kiosks, but technology still cannot solve collusive procurement or captured enforcement.

The verdict is conditional: digitisation reduces corruption when it redesigns the decision process and makes exceptions visible; otherwise it may give an old monopoly a faster interface. Procurement, maintenance, digital exclusion and grievance independence must also be audited throughout the project's life cycle.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Design an India-adapted anti-corruption strategy using Hong Kong's ICAC, Singapore's CPIB regime, the Korea attribution caveat, and the Finland-Thailand comparison. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

India should borrow mechanisms, not reputations. Hong Kong's ICAC supplies the organising architecture: enforcement, corruption prevention and community education work through distinct but connected departments. India can adapt this through Union, State and district networks rather than one city-scale campaign. Prevention teams should redesign high-risk services; education should use schools, professional bodies and local languages; investigators should remain operationally independent and reviewable.

Singapore contributes credible deterrence. CPIB's current official statement gives a maximum S\$100,000 fine or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years for Government or public-body contract corruption, plus repayment consequences. India should draw the lesson of certainty, asset tracing and equal reach, not copy sentence numbers without comparing legal systems and due process.

The ARC attributes extended family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that feature is lacking. It should not be asserted as current Korean law. Even hypothetically, collective liability would offend individual culpability; targeted beneficial-ownership scrutiny is a fairer adaptation.

CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2 and Thailand at 33 and rank 116 of 182. Finland's dispersed legal framework and Thailand's severe penalties caution that drafting or harshness alone cannot create integrity. India's package should combine transparent systems, protected voice, swift fair enforcement, civic norms and measured outcomes. The conclusion is selective adaptation governed by federal scale, constitutional rights and verified evidence.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Apply the rule-case mechanism and limitation method to workplace harassment, research ethics, refugee protection, communal violence and custodial justice. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

The method has four moves: state the governing rule, show the named case's mechanism, identify its remedy and retain its limitation. For workplace harassment, Vishaka derived preventive and redress duties from Articles 14, 15, 19(1)(g) and 21 until legislation. The 2013 statute supplies an Internal Committee and timelines, but formal constitution does not cure conflict or capture.

For research, ICMR's 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added protection for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight. A signed form is insufficient where recruitment is coercive or safety data is distorted; enforcement quality varies by institution.

For refugees, NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh confirms Article 21 protection for every person and required State protection of Chakma and Hajong refugees. Mohammad Salimullah's 2021 interim order declined deportation relief subject to lawful procedure; it must not be inflated into a final settlement of every non-refoulement question. Apply dignity and process without inventing an absolute right to remain.

Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries support retrospective truth and accountability but cannot replace immediate prevention, protection and lawful crisis command. D.K. Basu makes arrest records, communication and medical checks independent duties before guilt is known.

Thus named authority is useful only when linked to the decision mechanism and residual gap. The answer should move from rule to action, safeguard, review and qualified remedy, never from famous name to automatic conclusion. That discipline also prevents false equivalence across unlike institutional contexts.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Ethics | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-IV. **Core area:** Deeper synthesis of named Indian cases and comparative international models, extracting transferable institutional-design lessons while resisting hero-story simplification. **Grounded in:** 2nd ARC 4th Report *Ethics in Governance* (2007) - full-text-read sections on whistleblowers, parliamentary conduct, civil-society initiatives, e-governance, and comparative international models (National Colloquium annexures); audited GS-IV PYQs. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* basic/23_Comparative-and-Named-Real-Case-Studies.md.

1. Architecture

CASE CATEGORY	TRANSFERABLE LESSON	RESIDUAL LIMITATION (do not omit)
Whistleblowers (Manjunath, Dubey)	Individual courage exposes real, serious wrongdoing	Legal protection (2014 Act) still not brought into force; personal risk to whistleblowers persists
Parliamentary conduct (Mudgal, cash-for-questions)	Institutional self-discipline (Ethics Committees) CAN enforce expulsion when proof is clear	Only reaches EXPOSED cases (media exposé/complaint-triggered); no systemic prevention mechanism demonstrated by these cases
alone Civil-society/RTI capacity (MKSS, Parivartan)	Information access converts diffuse suspicion into actionable, provable evidence	Depends on organisational (MKSS, Parivartan were unusually well-organised; not
automatically E-governance (Gyandoot, Bhoomi vs CARD)	Removing discretion via automation reduces corruption WHERE the process is redesigned	replicable everywhere) Technology alone insufficient without matching PROCESS re-engineering (CARD's null
result) Comparative models transplantable (ICAC, Singapore, Korea, Finland, Thailand, Japan)	Distinct design philosophies: attitude change (HK), deterrent penalty+confiscation (Singapore), extended-liability (Korea)	No model is directly without adaptation to India's scale, federal structure and political economy (
Vivekananda's others," `02`)		"learn but do not become

Analytical claim: The advanced skill is extracting the **precise causal mechanism** behind each case's success or limitation (why did MKSS work? why did CARD not work despite similar technology to Bhoomi?) rather than treating the cases as generic illustrations of "civil society is good" or "technology helps."

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
ANALYSIS: Bhoomi vs CARD - the precise causal difference	Both were IT-enabled land/property-record reforms in the same ARC-era period; Bhoomi succeeded (per ARC's own 2002 independent-evaluation citation) partly because it fundamentally <i>automated</i> the mutation process itself (automatic notice generation, defined 30-day objection window, removing the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping role); CARD, per the ARC's own cited evaluation (Ramanathan and Balakrishnan, 2000), computerised record- <i>keeping</i> without necessarily removing the Sub-Registrar's discretionary approval role in the underlying transaction - illustrating that digitisation of <i>storage</i> without redesign of the <i>decision process</i> does not by itself reduce corruption.
FACT: MKSS's specific evidentiary mechanism	Not merely "civil society activism" in the abstract - MKSS's <i>Jan Sunwai</i> method specifically combined document access (muster rolls, vouchers, completion certificates) with public, community-witnessed cross-verification, converting private suspicion into publicly demonstrable, hard-to-deny evidence - a reproducible evidentiary technique, not just a generic advocacy campaign.
ANALYSIS: Institutional self-discipline's evidentiary limit	The Mudgal and cash-for-questions cases show Parliament <i>can</i> enforce its own ethical standards when wrongdoing is clearly, publicly proven (a sting operation, a floor-of-the-House admission) - but both cases were triggered by external exposure (a complaint, a television investigation), not by the Ethics Committees' own proactive detection, showing the mechanism is reactive/corrective rather than preventive.
ANALYSIS: Hero-story simplification (the specific risk this file guards against)	Presenting Manjunath/Dubey purely as martyrs whose deaths "led to reform" oversimplifies a still-incomplete legal process (the 2014 Act has never been commenced); presenting Bhoomi/Gyandoot as proof "technology solves corruption" ignores the ARC's own CARD counter-citation in the very same chapter; and repeating the Korea family-liability claim as verified fact ignores that it rests on a single annexure.

3. Detailed treatment

Whistleblowers - courage exposing a still-unresolved institutional gap

- FACT: Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey's deaths (2005, 2003 respectively) are the ARC's own cited evidentiary basis (Box 3.1) for its whistleblower-protection legislative recommendation.
- CURRENT: Nearly two decades later, the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 (assent 9 May 2014) has never been brought into force and the 2015 Amendment Bill lapsed (see 10, 19) - meaning the *specific institutional response* the ARC recommended in direct reaction to these two deaths remains unimplemented; a mature essay should state this gap explicitly rather than treating the cases as resolved history.
- ANALYSIS: The interim CVC PIDPI mechanism (Resolution No. 371/12/2002-AVD-III of 21 April 2004), while operative, is administrative rather than statutory, offering materially weaker legal protection than the unenforced 2014 Act would provide.

Parliamentary conduct - a reactive, not preventive, self-discipline mechanism

- FACT: Nehru's 1951 argument for Mudgal's expulsion ("the case is as bad as it could well be... the decision of the House should be... clear, precise and definite") established an early precedent that Parliament would treat proven corrupt conduct as intolerable, "unbecoming" of membership.
- FACT: The 2005 cash-for-questions case (triggered by an "Aaj Tak" telecast of 12 December 2005) showed

the same willingness to expel on clear evidence more than half a century later - ten Lok Sabha Members and, on the Rajya Sabha Ethics Committee's recommendation, one Rajya Sabha Member.

- ANALYSIS: Advanced critique: both precedents depended on an *external triggering event* (a specific complaint in 1951; a media sting in 2005) rather than the Ethics Committees' own proactive monitoring - meaning parliamentary self-discipline, while real, functions as a reactive *corrective*, not a preventive, mechanism; it does not by itself demonstrate that undetected similar conduct does not persist between such episodes.

Bhoomi/Gyandoot vs CARD - the precise design variable that determines success

- FACT: Bhoomi (Karnataka): automated mutation-notice generation with a defined 30-day objection window materially reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping role in the mutation process itself, not merely digitising the record afterward.

- FACT: Gyandoot (Madhya Pradesh): panchayat/community-funded, youth-run kiosks for land-record copies, agricultural rates and grievance registration similarly reduced discretionary human intermediation at the point of citizen contact.

- FACT: CARD (Andhra Pradesh): per the ARC's own cited evaluation, computerisation did not produce a measurable difference in corruption levels between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices - ANALYSIS: the most defensible explanation, consistent with the ARC's own broader "reduce discretion, not just digitise records" logic (01, 17), is that CARD computerised record storage without equivalently redesigning the underlying discretionary approval/valuation process at the point of the transaction.

- ANALYSIS: This is the single most important comparative lesson for Mains essay answers on e-governance and corruption: **digitisation of storage is not the same as automation of discretion**, and only the latter reliably reduces corruption.

Comparative international models - three genuinely distinct design philosophies

- FACT: **Hong Kong's ICAC** (1974) represents an **attitude-change/social-norm** philosophy - its official three-pronged strategy pairs law enforcement with corruption prevention and sustained community education (school programmes, community outreach, the *ICAC Investigators* drama series) to shift the *social acceptability* of corruption.

- FACT: **Singapore's CPIB regime** represents a **deterrent-penalty-plus-asset-confiscation** philosophy. The ARC's **2007 annexure** recorded the then penalty and confiscation framework; those figures must not be presented as current law. CURRENT: Under the Prevention of Corruption Act 1960 as it stands, sections 5-6 carry a fine up to S\$100,000 or up to five years' imprisonment, or both, per charge, and section 7 raises imprisonment to seven years where the matter concerns a Government or public-body contract; the 1989 confiscation statute the ARC names was repealed in 1999 and replaced by the CDSA 1992 regime.

- ANALYSIS: **Korea's 1975 reform** is cited by the ARC for an **extended-liability/reputational** philosophy - extending consequences beyond the corrupt official to their family and even the person who recommended them. ANALYSIS: Independent corroboration exists for the 1975 movement and for re-employment restrictions, but **not** for the family/recommender extension; present it as the ARC's account and, if using it as a model, discuss it hypothetically rather than as verified comparative practice.

- ANALYSIS: **Finland's** case is analytically important precisely because it demonstrates that a nation's *overall institutional culture, transparency and rule-of-law strength* - not the precision of a single statutory definition - is the more decisive variable. State it exactly: Finland has no separate anti-corruption statute or statutory definition of the forms of corruption, but bribery offences do exist in its Criminal Code (a useful corrective against over-indexing on legal drafting, directly relevant to 19's discussion of the PC Act's definitional gaps).

- ANALYSIS: **Thailand's** severe-penalty/high-corruption combination is the ARC's own cited counter-example to a pure deterrence theory, reinforcing (alongside CARD) that no single lever (technology, penalty severity) is sufficient alone without complementary institutional and cultural conditions.

Vivekananda's caution applied to comparative-model borrowing

- ANALYSIS: Applying 02's Vivekananda principle ("learn... but do not become others") to this topic: Hong

Kong's ICAC model presumes a relatively compact, city-state administrative geography enabling intensive public-education saturation; India's continental scale and federal structure would require adapting (not directly replicating) the ICAC's public-education intensity, likely through state/district-level campaigns rather than a single national one - a concrete, source-grounded application of the selective-adaptation principle rather than uncritical model import.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- ANALYSIS: A comprehensive Indian reform combining these lessons would: (1) enforce the Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 (closing the Manjunath/Dubey-motivated gap); (2) require e-governance reforms to demonstrate discretion-removal (not merely record digitisation) before being certified as anti-corruption measures, learning from the Bhoomi/CARD contrast; (3) study Korea's extended- liability model for adaptation (with appropriate due-process safeguards, given its intrusion on family members' rights) in high-value corruption cases; (4) invest in sustained, ICAC-style public education at the state/district level, adapted to India's federal structure.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: A state government evaluating whether to scale up a computerisation project should specifically audit whether the reform removes discretionary approval steps (Bhoomi-style) or merely digitises existing paper records (CARD-style risk) before claiming an anti-corruption benefit.
- ANALYSIS: Boundary case: Korea's extended-family-liability model, while a strong deterrent, raises a genuine ethical concern about collective/vicarious liability being imposed on family members who did not themselves commit any wrongdoing - a limitation any Indian adaptation would need to address through narrower, more individually-targeted mechanisms (e.g., enhanced scrutiny of family assets rather than automatic employment bans on relatives).

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: Civil-society-led accountability mechanisms (MKSS, Parivartan) depend on organisational capacity, leadership quality and local context that are not automatically replicable everywhere - treating them as a universal template risks understating the real capacity-building investment required.
- ANALYSIS: E-governance discretion-removal, while effective against certain corruption types (mutation delay, record-access denial), does not address collusive corruption in procurement/large contracts (see 18), which requires separate, targeted systemic reform.
- ANALYSIS: Comparative international models each carry context-specific trade-offs (ICAC's intensive public-education cost; Singapore's severe-penalty regime's due-process considerations; Korea's family- liability model's fairness concerns) that must be weighed, not merely admired, before adaptation.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: ARC's own citation (Ramanathan and Balakrishnan, 2000) is the specific source for CARD's null-result finding on corruption reduction, directly contrasting with Bhoomi's positive 2002 independent evaluation.
- ANALYSIS: ARC's Colloquium annexure attributes to Korea's 1975 General Administrative Reform Movement an extension of anti-corruption consequences to a dismissed official's sons, grandsons and original recommender. Independent corroboration was not found for the family/recommender extension - attribute it to the ARC, not to Korean law.
- FACT: The ARC's reference to Singapore's 1989 confiscation law is a **historical 2007 source description**; that Act was repealed in 1999 and confiscation now runs through the Corruption, Drug Trafficking and Other Serious Crimes (Confiscation of Benefits) Act 1992. Check Singapore Statutes Online/CPIB before citing any penalty as present law.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: Bhoomi and CARD used fundamentally different technology, explaining their different outcomes. ->

Both were broadly similar IT-enabled record-computerisation reforms of the same ARC-era period; the ARC's own analysis attributes the different outcomes to whether the underlying discretionary process was redesigned (Bhoomi) or left largely intact (CARD), not to differing technology per se.

- WRONG: The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 was enacted directly in response to, and immediately protected, whistleblowers like Manjunath and Dubey. -> The Act was enacted nearly a decade after their deaths and, per current verified status, remains not brought into force even now.

- WRONG: Korea's extended-family-liability model has been adopted in India's anti-corruption law. ->

It is a comparative model recorded in the ARC's colloquium annexure, cited for analytical contrast, not an implemented feature of Indian law - and the family/recommender element itself is uncorroborated outside that annexure.

- WRONG: Singapore's corruption penalties are those the 2nd ARC recorded in 2007. -> Those are historical figures; the current statutory maxima under the Prevention of Corruption Act 1960 are S\$100,000 or five years (seven years for Government/public-body contract matters).

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor application

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 (assent 9 May 2014) never brought into force; 2015 Amendment Bill lapsed; CVC's PIDPI Resolution of 21 April 2004 remains the operative interim mechanism	Confirms, as of 4 August 2026, that the specific legal gap the Manjunath/Dubey cases exposed remains unresolved - essential for avoiding a hero-story-simplified answer.
CURRENT: CPI 2025: Finland 88/100 (rank 2 of 182); Thailand 33/100 (rank 116 of 182)	Lets a comparative answer use current, dated figures instead of the ARC's 2007-era rankings.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Any essay/theory question inviting comparative or historical anti-corruption analysis should explicitly pair a success case with its documented limitation (Bhoomi with CARD; MKSS/Parivartan with the capacity-dependency caveat; ICAC with the scale-adaptation caveat) to demonstrate the balanced, source-grounded synthesis this file models.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: India's and the world's most-cited anti-corruption cases each carry a precise, extractable causal mechanism and an honest, source-grounded limitation; a mature GS-IV answer names both - success mechanism and residual gap - rather than collapsing the historical record into a simplified, uniformly triumphant narrative.

1. Name the specific case/model precisely, with its source and date.
2. State the precise causal mechanism behind its success (or, for CARD/Thailand-type cases, its specific reason for limited effect).
3. State the case's honestly acknowledged, currently verified limitation or unresolved gap.
4. Where borrowing a comparative model, apply the Vivekananda-style selective-adaptation principle (02) explicitly, naming the specific adaptation India's scale/federal structure would require.
5. Conclude with a specific, mechanism-targeted (not generic) reform recommendation.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims**: What specific finding did the ARC-cited 2000 evaluation of the CARD project report?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks)**: Compare Bhoomi and CARD to explain why similar e-governance technology produced different anti-corruption outcomes.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks)**: Drawing on Hong Kong's ICAC, Singapore's CPIB and Korea's 1975 reform, design a comparative-model-informed, India-adapted anti-corruption reform package.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: `basic/23_Comparative-and-Named-Real-Case-Studies.md`.
- FACT: `01_Ethics-and-Human-Interface.md` - the discretion-reduction principle explaining Bhoomi vs CARD.
- FACT: `19_Corruption-Legal-Framework.md` - the whistleblower-protection status these cases motivated.
- FACT: `02_Human-Values-and-Lessons-from-Leaders.md` - Vivekananda's selective-adaptation principle.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance**: Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented**: 2018
- **Paper(s)**: GS-IV
- **Routed question demands**: 1

Semantic table split - Year

- **Year**: 2018
- **Paper**: GS-IV
- **Q**: 12
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering)**: Edward Snowden released classified government surveillance documents citing moral obligation to inform public; ethically justified even if legally prohibited - weighing competing values
- **Directive / format**: Case study · 20 marks · 250 words
- **Source status**: Case routed to Ethics case-study method
- **Owner requirement**: Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Edward Snowden released classified government surveillance documents citing moral obligation to inform public; ethically justified even if legally prohibited - weighing competing values

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

EMBEDDED TWELVE-PANEL ASCII REVISION ATLAS

The panels compress the learning route without replacing the complete teaching and solved practice above.

ASCII PANEL 1/12 - 1. Named-case reasoning chain

CENTRAL FOCUS

1. Named-case reasoning chain

- [1] Name the authority and date
 - |
 - v
- [2] Identify the governing rule
 - |
 - v
- [3] Extract the causal mechanism
 - |
 - v
- [4] Connect evidence to the claim
 - |
 - v
- [5] State the institutional remedy
 - |
 - v
- [6] Retain the residual limitation
 - |
 - v
- [7] Test transfer to new facts
 - |
 - v
- [8] Give a qualified verdict
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> A famous name earns marks only when it changes the reasoning.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the opening method for every comparative answer.

ASCII PANEL 2/12 - 2. Whistleblower protection architecture

CENTRAL FOCUS

2. Whistleblower protection architecture

- [1] Receive through secure channel
 - |
 - v
- [2] Separate identity from allegation
 - |
 - v
- [3] Assess physical and service risk
 - |
 - v
- [4] Preserve evidence independently
 - |
 - v
- [5] Restrict and log identity access
 - |
 - v
- [6] Investigate outside accused chain
 - |
 - v
- [7] Prevent and remedy retaliation
 - |
 - v
- [8] Report outcome with fair process
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> Manjunath and Dubey show why courage requires a protection system.

ANSWER USE -> Use for whistleblower PYQs and integrity case studies.

ASCII PANEL 3/12 - 3. Parliamentary ethics comparison

CENTRAL FOCUS

3. Parliamentary ethics comparison

- [1] Mudgal: paid parliamentary favour
 - |
 - v
- [2] Mudgal: committee found misconduct
 - |
 - v
- [3] Mudgal: House chose expulsion
 - |
 - v
- [4] 2005: external media exposure
 - |
 - v
- [5] Lok Sabha: ten expelled
 - |
 - v
- [6] Rajya Sabha: one expelled
 - |
 - v
- [7] Strength: corrective discipline
 - |
 - v
- [8] Limit: reactive detection
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> The Houses proved corrective power, not comprehensive prevention.

ANSWER USE -> Use to balance institutional self-discipline with reform.

ASCII PANEL 4/12 - 4. Citizen evidence chain

CENTRAL FOCUS

4. Citizen evidence chain

- [1] Obtain official records
 - |
 - v
- [2] Make records locally intelligible
 - |
 - v
- [3] Compare claim with lived delivery
 - |
 - v
- [4] Use community witness and hearing
 - |
 - v
- [5] Record contradiction precisely
 - |
 - v
- [6] Route proof to competent authority
 - |
 - v
- [7] Demand action-taken disclosure
 - |
 - v
- [8] Protect participants from retaliation
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> MKSS and Parivartan convert information access into testable accountability.

ANSWER USE -> Use for RTI, social audit and civil-society answers.

ASCII PANEL 5/12 - 5. Bhoomi versus CARD

CENTRAL FOCUS

5. Bhoomi versus CARD

- [1] Both used digital administration
 - |
 - v
- [2] Bhoomi improved record access
 - |
 - v
- [3] Bhoomi automated mutation notice
 - |
 - v
- [4] Bhoomi defined objection timing
 - |
 - v
- [5] CARD digitised registration work
 - |
 - v
- [6] CARD evaluation found no gap
 - |
 - v
- [7] Key variable: decision discretion
 - |
 - v
- [8] Test outcome, not computer count
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> Digitised storage is not equivalent to redesigned discretion.

ANSWER USE -> Use for e-governance, corruption and service-delivery questions.

ASCII PANEL 6/12 - 6. Comparative anti-corruption models

CENTRAL FOCUS

6. Comparative anti-corruption models

- [1] ICAC: enforcement
 - |
 - v
- [2] ICAC: prevention
 - |
 - v
- [3] ICAC: community education
 - |
 - v
- [4] CPIB: credible deterrence
 - |
 - v
- [5] CPIB: current penalty precision
 - |
 - v
- [6] Korea: attribute ARC claim
 - |
 - v
- [7] Finland: broad integrity ecology
 - |
 - v
- [8] Thailand: severity is insufficient
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> No single lever or foreign model is self-executing.

ANSWER USE -> Use to design selective, India-specific adaptation.

ASCII PANEL 7/12 - 7. Vishaka to workplace statute

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Vishaka to workplace statute

- [1] Harassment violates constitutional rights
 - |
 - v
- [2] Court filled legislative vacuum
 - |
 - v
- [3] Guidelines bound workplaces
 - |
 - v
- [4] Directions lasted until legislation
 - |
 - v
- [5] 2013 law created formal process
 - |
 - v
- [6] Internal Committee handles complaints
 - |
 - v
- [7] Conflict can still impair fairness
 - |
 - v
- [8] Safety and hearing must coexist
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> A statutory forum needs impartial operation, not paper existence alone.

ANSWER USE -> Use for gender, dignity and institutional-design answers.

ASCII PANEL 8/12 - 8. ICMR research-ethics gate

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. ICMR research-ethics gate

- [1] Explain purpose and procedure
 - |
 - v
- [2] Disclose risk and expected benefit
 - |
 - v
- [3] Ensure voluntary participation
 - |
 - v
- [4] Protect withdrawal without penalty
 - |
 - v
- [5] Add safeguards for vulnerability
 - |
 - v
- [6] Review through Ethics Committee
 - |
 - v
- [7] Report adverse events fully
 - |
 - v
- [8] Reassess consent when facts change
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> A signature cannot cure coercion, concealment or weak oversight.

ANSWER USE -> Use for clinical research and vulnerable-participant cases.

ASCII PANEL 9/12 - 9. Refugee-rights paired reading

CENTRAL FOCUS

9. Refugee-rights paired reading

- [1] NHRC: Article 21 covers every person
 - |
 - v
- [2] State must prevent threatened violence
 - |
 - v
- [3] Claims require lawful processing
 - |
 - v
- [4] Protection is not automatic residence
 - |
 - v
- [5] Salimullah: interim order
 - |
 - v
- [6] Interim stay was declined
 - |
 - v
- [7] Removal still needs lawful procedure
 - |
 - v
- [8] Customary-law debate not finally closed
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> Hold dignity and lawful removal authority together without absolutes.

ANSWER USE -> Use for refugee, non-citizen and constitutional-morality answers.

ASCII PANEL 10/12 - 10. Crisis action versus later inquiry

CENTRAL FOCUS

10. Crisis action versus later inquiry

- [1] Monitor tension and credible rumour
 - |
 - v
- [2] Use representative peace channels
 - |
 - v
- [3] Protect vulnerable locations
 - |
 - v
- [4] Apply lawful proportionate policing
 - |
 - v
- [5] Preserve command and incident records
 - |
 - v
- [6] Bhagalpur inquiry studies failure
 - |
 - v
- [7] Nanavati inquiry assigns retrospective lessons
 - |
 - v
- [8] Implement findings through reform
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> A commission explains the past; administration must still prevent present harm.

ANSWER USE -> Use for communal peace and accountability case studies.

ASCII PANEL 11/12 - 11. D.K. Basu custody safeguards

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. D.K. Basu custody safeguards

- [1] Identify arresting personnel
|
v
- [2] Prepare witnessed arrest memo
|
v
- [3] Inform friend or relative
|
v
- [4] Record place and time of custody
|
v
- [5] Document injuries and medical checks
|
v
- [6] Maintain custody diary entries
|
v
- [7] Provide magistrate visibility
|
v
- [8] Treat compliance as independent duty
|
v

VERDICT -> Procedural dignity applies before the State knows final guilt.

ANSWER USE -> Use for police ethics, rule of law and constitutional morality.

ASCII PANEL 12/12 - 12. Examiner-ready answer spine

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. Examiner-ready answer spine

- [1] Open with direct ethical thesis
|
v
- [2] Choose two genuinely comparable cases
|
v
- [3] State each rule and exact mechanism
|
v
- [4] Explain what the evidence proves
|
v
- [5] Add current law or figure carefully
|
v
- [6] Name limitation and contrary evidence
|
v
- [7] Adapt remedy to Indian institutions
|
v
- [8] Conclude with qualified transfer
|
v

VERDICT -> Case plus mechanism plus limitation is stronger than a catalogue of heroes.

ANSWER USE -> Use to structure 10-, 15- and 20-mark responses.

ONE-PAGE CONCEPT GRID

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Manjunath and Dubey reveal an unresolved protection gap	Manjunath Shanmugam and Satyendra Dubey exposed serious wrongdoing and were killed, but their ethical significance lies in the continuing need for safe reporting, identity protection, risk response and credible follow-up rather than martyrdom alone.
The 2014 protection statute is not operational merely because enacted	The Whistle Blowers Protection Act received assent in 2014 but requires a commencement notification; an official Lok Sabha answer in 2025 stated that it had not been brought into force, while the administrative PIDPI route continued.
Confidentiality is a process, not a slogan	Effective whistleblower protection requires restricted identity access, secure evidence storage, retaliation monitoring, emergency risk measures and independent review; merely labelling a complaint confidential does not control who can trace or punish the informant.
A whistleblower allegation still requires fair verification	The public value of disclosure does not convert allegation into guilt; institutions must protect the informant while authenticating records, defining the charge, hearing affected persons and leaving final responsibility to the competent forum.
Mudgal established a parliamentary corrective precedent	The 1951 H.G. Mudgal case showed that the House could treat proven acceptance of benefits for parliamentary favours as conduct incompatible with membership and use expulsion as institutional self-discipline.
Cash-for-questions confirms power but also reactivity	The 2005 cash-for-questions episode led to expulsion of ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member, yet the process followed external exposure; it proves corrective capacity more clearly than proactive detection.
MKSS Jan Sunwai converts records into public proof	MKSS combined official muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates with community-witnessed public hearings, allowing villagers to cross-check paper claims against work, payment and local knowledge.
Parivartan made PDS diversion testable through RTI	Parivartan used access to fair-price-shop stock registers to compare recorded grain and oil with actual distribution, turning diffuse suspicion of diversion into a transaction-level accountability claim.
Gyandoot reduced costly human intermediation	Gyandoot used locally operated kiosks to provide land records, market rates, applications, grievances and benefit information; its anti-corruption value arose from accessible services and reduced dependence on discretionary intermediaries.
Bhoomi changed the mutation workflow	Bhoomi did more than digitise land records: automatic mutation notices, a defined objection period and kiosk access altered the workflow and reduced the revenue official's discretionary gatekeeping over routine transactions.
CARD is the necessary digital-government counter-example	The ARC-cited evaluation of Andhra Pradesh's CARD project found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised Sub-Registrar Offices, warning that digitised records alone may leave discretionary decisions intact.
Technology must be tied to the corruption mechanism	Bhoomi and CARD should be compared through the decision process: automation, notice, deadlines and auditability can reduce gatekeeping, while digitising storage without changing approval power may reproduce the same rent opportunity.

CORE REVISION SPINE

- **Hong Kong ICAC uses three mutually supporting prongs:** Hong Kong's ICAC links law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education through specialised departments; the model treats punishment, system repair and social norms as complements rather than interchangeable substitutes.
- **Singapore penalties must use current official figures:** Singapore's CPIB states that the current general maximum is S\$100,000 or five years' imprisonment or both per count, rising to seven years where corruption concerns a Government or public-body contract.
- **Korea's wider liability claim requires attribution:** The ARC annexure attributes family and recommender consequences to Korea's 1975 reform, but independent corroboration for that extension is lacking; it should be presented as the ARC's account, not verified current Korean law.
- **Finland and Thailand defeat single-lever explanations:** CPI 2025 placed Finland at 88 and rank 2, while Thailand stood at 33 and rank 116 of 182; paired with their legal contexts, the figures caution against equating statutory severity alone with integrity.
- **Vishaka was binding interim judicial law:** Vishaka treated workplace sexual harassment as violating constitutional guarantees and issued binding guidelines until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute later created a detailed preventive and redress framework.
- **A statutory committee is not automatically impartial:** The workplace statute mandates an Internal Committee and procedural timelines, but formal constitution cannot cure a personal conflict, employer capture or unsafe reporting culture; fair composition and reasoned process remain essential.
- **ICMR ethics makes consent an ongoing protection:** The ICMR 2017 guidelines require comprehensible voluntary consent, added safeguards for vulnerable participants and continuing Ethics Committee oversight; a signed form cannot validate concealment, coercion or distorted safety reporting.
- **Guidelines depend on institutional enforcement quality:** ICMR guidance supplies substantive standards, but site-level protection depends on an independent and competent Ethics Committee that reviews risk, consent, vulnerability, safety reporting and protocol deviations without sponsor capture.
- **NHRC v Arunachal Pradesh protects every person's life:** NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh applied Article 21 to Chakma and Hajong refugees and required State protection from forcible eviction and violence, demonstrating that life and personal liberty are not confined to citizens.
- **Salimullah is an interim-order authority with limits:** Mohammad Salimullah's 8 April 2021 order declined interim protection against deportation, required lawful procedure and discussed citizen-only residence rights; it did not finally determine every customary non-refoulement argument in the underlying dispute.
- **Bhagalpur and Nanavati are retrospective accountability tools:** The Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiries can identify causes, responsibility and institutional failure after communal violence, but their fact-finding cannot substitute for timely intelligence, lawful crowd control, protection and confidence-building during a crisis.
- **D.K. Basu safeguards operate before guilt is known:** D.K. Basu made arrest documentation, communication, medical examination, custody records and magisterial visibility procedural safeguards against abuse; compliance is required independently of whether the detainee is later convicted.

SOURCE AND ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

Topic 23 owns the disciplined use of named evidence, not the complete law of every domain it touches. The 2nd ARC's Ethics in Governance report controls its accounts of Manjunath Shanmugam, Satyendra Dubey, H.G. Mudgal, cash-for-questions, MKSS Jan Sunwai, Parivartan, Gyandoot, Bhoomi, CARD and the comparative annexure. Manjunath and Dubey must establish the protection mechanism and unresolved gap, not a heroic narrative. Mudgal and cash-for-questions establish reactive parliamentary corrective capacity, not proof of preventive detection. MKSS and Parivartan work through documentary access plus public or beneficiary verification; a social-audit finding is evidence for action, not conviction. Bhoomi must be compared with CARD through process redesign and discretion, not technology branding. Singapore's ARC-era figures are historical; current penalties must follow CPIB or Singapore Statutes Online. The Korea family and recommender claim is attributed to the ARC annexure because independent corroboration was not found. CPI 2025 figures are comparative perception data, not causal proof. Vishaka was binding interim judicial law until legislation; the 2013 workplace statute now supplies the formal process, whose practical impartiality must still be tested. ICMR's 2017 research guidance supplies consent, vulnerability and Ethics

Committee standards but is not one central criminal code. NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh confirms Article 21 protection for every person without creating an automatic right to remain. Mohammad Salimullah is an interim order of 8 April 2021 declining the requested restraint subject to lawful procedure; do not describe it as a final settlement of every non-refoulement argument. Bhagalpur and Nanavati inquiry materials are retrospective accountability evidence, not substitutes for real-time prevention. D.K. Basu safeguards are procedural duties independent of ultimate guilt; current statutory numbering should be checked under the BNSS before use. Official local UPSC PDFs control PYQ wording. Condensed case-study entries are neutral routing where stated and do not pretend to reproduce every printed fact. A named case should always be written through rule, mechanism, application, remedy and limitation.

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the precise ethical concept or teaching.
2. State a qualified thesis rather than a moral slogan.
3. Explain the causal or decision-making mechanism.
4. Add one specific Indian administrative illustration.
5. Test the strongest limitation or attribution caveat.
6. End with a practical, institution-aware verdict.

COMPARATIVE AND NAMED REAL CASES RAPID REGISTER

1. THE RULE-CASE-MECHANISM-LIMIT METHOD

- Do not write a hero list.
- Start with the governing ethical or legal rule.
- Name the case, institution, date and source only when relevant.
- State the causal mechanism: what changed behaviour, evidence, discretion or remedy?
- Explain what the named evidence proves for the question.
- Add the residual limitation, counter-example or unresolved status.
- Transfer the mechanism, not the prestige of the name, to the new facts.
- End with a qualified remedy and verdict.

2. MANJUNATH SHANMUGAM AND SATYENDRA DUBEY

- Manjunath: IOC officer opposing fuel adulteration; killed 19 November 2005.
- Dubey: NHAI engineer exposing road-construction corruption; killed 27 November 2003.
- Core value: integrity plus moral courage.
- Mechanism lesson: secure reporting, identity separation, threat response, independent evidence custody and anti-retaliation.
- Official Lok Sabha answer dated 3 December 2025: Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 had not been brought into force.
- PIDPI is an administrative route; do not equate it with a commenced statutory shield.
- Limitation: protection never turns allegation into guilt; independent verification remains necessary.
- Best thesis: courage exposes wrongdoing, but institutions must make courage survivable and consequential.

3. MUDGAL AND CASH-FOR-QUESTIONS

- H.G. Mudgal, 1951: acceptance of money or benefits for parliamentary favours; House accepted expulsion.
- Cash-for-questions, 2005: ten Lok Sabha members and one Rajya Sabha member expelled.
- Strength: Parliament can enforce ethical boundaries against its own members on clear evidence.
- Mechanism: inquiry, recorded findings, House action and reputational defence of membership.
- Limitation: both were complaint or exposure triggered; the cases show corrective more than preventive capacity.
- Do not imply expulsion replaces any separately applicable criminal or legal process.
- Reform route: disclosure registers, proactive ethics monitoring, fair inquiry and reasoned public consequence.

4. MKSS JAN SUNWAI AND PARIVARTAN

- MKSS: muster rolls, vouchers, beneficiary lists and completion certificates cross-checked in public hearings.
- Specific mechanism: record access + community witness + public contradiction + action demand.
- Rajasthan later empowered ward sabhas with social-audit functions.
- Parivartan: RTI access to fair-price-shop stock registers exposed PDS diversion.
- Specific mechanism: recorded stock compared with beneficiary delivery.
- Shared lesson: information becomes accountability only when intelligible, verifiable and linked to consequence.
- Limitation: organisational capacity, local safety, record quality and follow-up are not automatic.
- Social-audit evidence informs action; it does not itself adjudicate guilt.

5. GYANDOOT, BHOOMI AND CARD

- Gyandoot: community-linked kiosks reduced citizen dependence on intermediaries for records, rates, applications and grievances.
- Bhoomi: computerised land records plus automatic mutation notice and defined objection timing.
- Bhoomi mechanism: accessible record + workflow automation + reduced discretionary gatekeeping + audit trail.
- CARD: ARC-cited 2000 evaluation found no significant corruption difference between computerised and non-computerised offices.
- CARD lesson: digital storage can preserve opaque valuation, approval and monopoly discretion.
- Best comparison: similar digital reform, different redesign of the decision process.
- Project test: map rent point, remove avoidable discretion, log override, publish fee and deadline, measure citizen outcome.
- Limitation: service digitisation does not by itself solve collusive procurement or captured enforcement.

6. HONG KONG, SINGAPORE AND KOREA

- Hong Kong ICAC established in 1974.
- Three prongs: law enforcement, corruption prevention and community education.
- Mechanism: punish wrongdoing, redesign opportunity and change social tolerance together.
- Singapore CPIB current official maximum: S\$100,000 or five years or both per count.
- Government or public-body contract matter: imprisonment maximum rises to seven years.
- Do not repeat the ARC's 2007 fine as current law.
- Korea: ARC attributes wider family and recommender consequences to a 1975 reform.
- Caveat: use only as an ARC-attributed claim; independent corroboration for that extension is lacking.
- Ethical limit: collective liability conflicts with individual culpability; targeted asset scrutiny is safer.

7. FINLAND AND THAILAND

- CPI 2025: Finland 88/100, rank 2 of 182.
- CPI 2025: Thailand 33/100, rank 116 of 182.
- Finland has no single dedicated anti-corruption statute, but bribery and related wrongdoing are criminalised through broader law.
- Thailand's severe sanctions do not by themselves establish low corruption.
- CPI measures perceptions of public-sector corruption; it is not direct prevalence or causal proof.
- Comparative thesis: rule of law, transparency, enforcement certainty, civic norms and institutional trust interact.
- Never infer that one statute, one agency or sentence severity explains a country's score.

8. VISHAKA AND THE 2013 WORKPLACE LAW

- Vishaka, decided 13 August 1997: workplace sexual harassment violates Articles 14, 15, 19(1)(g) and 21.
- Court issued binding guidelines until Parliament legislated.
- The guidelines operated for sixteen years before the 2013 statute.
- The statute mandates a workplace complaint and redress structure, including an Internal Committee.

- Mechanism: prevention duties + safe complaint + inquiry + recommendation + employer action.
- Limitation: formal committee existence does not cure conflict, employer capture or retaliation.
- Case-study rule: protect complainant safety and confidentiality while preserving fair hearing and reasoned findings.

9. ICMR RESEARCH ETHICS

- ICMR National Ethical Guidelines, 2017: informed consent is a comprehensible, voluntary process.
- Explain purpose, procedure, risk, benefit, privacy, withdrawal and relevant alternatives.
- Vulnerable participants require additional justification and safeguards.
- Institutional Ethics Committee oversight continues beyond initial approval.
- Safety data and protocol deviations must not be distorted or withheld.
- A signed form cannot cure coercion, therapeutic misconception or material concealment.
- Limitation: implementation depends on the independence and competence of the site-level committee.

10. NHRC v ARUNACHAL PRADESH AND SALIMULLAH

- NHRC v State of Arunachal Pradesh, 1996: Article 21 protects every person, not citizens alone.
- State had to protect Chakma and Hajong refugees from threatened eviction and violence.
- The judgment does not create a general automatic right to remain in India.
- Mohammad Salimullah order dated 8 April 2021 was an interim-order decision on requested relief.
- The Court declined release and restraint on deportation, while requiring prescribed procedure.
- Do not present the order as a final settlement of every customary non-refoulement argument.
- Paired rule: universal life and due-process protection + lawful authority questions considered separately.
- Avoid both automatic-protection and automatic-deportation answers.

11. BHAGALPUR, NANAVALI AND D.K. BASU

- Bhagalpur 1989 inquiry: retrospective examination of communal violence and administrative or police failure.
- Nanavati Commission, constituted 2000: retrospective inquiry into the 1984 anti-Sikh violence.
- Commission mechanism: preserve evidence, reconstruct events, identify failure and recommend reform.
- Limitation: later inquiry cannot replace real-time intelligence, protection, lawful policing and peacebuilding.
- D.K. Basu, decided 18 December 1996: eleven safeguards governing arrest and custody.
- High-yield safeguards: arrest memo, relative or friend information, custody record, injury record, medical checks and magistrate visibility.
- Compliance is an independent constitutional duty regardless of eventual guilt.
- Current statutory citations should use verified BNSS numbering, not assumed Cr.P.C. numbers.

12. PYQ AND ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

- Whistleblower PYQ: Manjunath + Dubey -> courage, risk, legal status, secure protection architecture.
- Social-audit PYQ: MKSS + Parivartan -> documentary access, public verification, competent follow-up.
- Probity PYQ: Bhoomi + CARD -> system design and measured outcome; ICAC -> culture plus institution.
- Core-values PYQ: Finland + Thailand -> sanctions are necessary but insufficient.
- Gender PYQ: Vishaka + 2013 law -> constitutional foundation, statutory process, implementation conflict.
- Constitutional-morality PYQ: NHRC + D.K. Basu + cautious Salimullah use -> dignity and lawful procedure.
- Communal case study: immediate prevention first; Bhagalpur or Nanavati inquiry is later accountability.
- Comparison formula: common question -> mechanism A -> mechanism B -> difference -> limits -> India-adapted remedy.
- Evidence formula: claim -> named case -> what it proves -> limitation or qualification.
- Final verdict: use named cases as transferable institutional reasoning, never decorative authority.

Final thesis: A high-quality GS-IV answer does not celebrate a case name and stop. It identifies the rule, explains the causal mechanism, shows what the evidence proves, retains the unresolved limitation and adapts the remedy to the new facts. Manjunath and Dubey, Mudgal and cash-for-questions, MKSS and Parivartan, Bhoomi and CARD, ICAC and CPIB, Vishaka and the workplace statute, NHRC and Salimullah, the inquiry commissions and D.K. Basu are therefore reasoning tools, not hero stories.